

Muller and Strom 1999 RG Notes

Müller, Wolfgang C., and Kaare Strøm, eds. *Policy, Office, or Votes? How Political Parties in Western Europe Make Hard Decisions*.

Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 1999.

1 Main Idea

2 General Notes

- Parties have three possible goals: shaping policy, holding office, or gaining votes. These goals are not necessarily complimentary (and indeed are often in conflict) – cannot be maximized simultaneously
- Consider a party as three leading actors: its elected officials, its central leadership, and its members/activists, all of whom have different priorities regarding the above goals

3 Important Specific Factual Claims

- Suggests that refusing office is a means of pursuing policy or vote-maximization goals

4 Connections

- Harmel & Janda 1994 – discusses party goals as varying between policy, office, or votes. Also discuss a fourth motivation: democracy-seeking

5 My Critiques

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